

Safe And Sound—And Secure

Q I currently have Windows XP Professional, and I want to reinstall XP. I have many files encrypted in my NTFS partition, and I want to be able to access them after reinstalling Windows. How do I do this?

Sarvesh Tonk

A Many people commit the blunder of encrypting files in an NTFS partition and then installing Windows afresh. There is no way of recovering the encrypted files once this is done. Therefore, making a backup of the encryption certificate is of utmost importance.

In the Run dialog box, enter `mmc` and click OK. This will start the Microsoft Management Console. Select **File > Add/Remove Snap-in**. Now click on **Add** and select the **Certificates snap-in** from the list, and click **Add**. Then

click on **Finish**, **Close**, and **OK**. Go to **Certificates—Current User > Personal > Certificates**. Click the certificate that displays the words **File Recovery under Intended Purposes**. Right-click the certificate, point to **All Tasks**, and then click **Export**. Follow the instructions in the **Certificate Export Wizard** to export the certificate and associated private key to the **Personal Information Exchange** or **.pfx** format. Make sure you **deselect Delete the private key** if the export is successful. You will be asked to password-protect your keys (to verify when importing later on). Save this **.pfx** file to a floppy disk or to some other secure location.

Now, when you format, or if your keys get damaged, all you need to do is double-click on the exported key and follow the Wizard. You should get access to your files.



Illustrations Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

your Trash folder are subject to deletion at any time." Mail that is deleted can only be retrieved for sure during the session in which it was deleted; it could be lost forever after you log out of the session.

Try and contact Yahoo! Customer Care at <http://help.yahoo.com/help/us/payforcare/payforcare-01.html>. We would like to state that you need to be a paid subscriber to get help from here.

Pirates Burning (In) Hell!

Q I installed Nero 7 on my Windows XP computer and registered it successfully. But after a few days, it suddenly started functioning in trial mode, and when I tried to enter the registration code, it said the code was incorrect. I uninstalled and reinstalled the application, but to no avail.

Shamit Kumar

A This happens when you use a blacklisted key to register Nero. It may work for a few days, and it will stop functioning when Nero finds out that the key is blacklisted. If you haven't purchased this copy of Nero 7, please do so at www.nero.com—it costs \$79.99 (Rs 3,250). If you do own a legitimate copy, please get in touch with Nero support at <http://support.nero.com>.

Frozen Frame

Q I have a Pentium IV 3.0 GHz, 512 MB RAM, 128 MB graphics card (NVIDIA GeForce FX 5200), and Windows XP SP2. When I play games like *Cricket 2005*, *Need for Speed: Most Wanted*, and more, the games freeze after 10 to 15 minutes. Some older games also freeze. Why is this happening?

Pugalenthi Iniabarathi

A It is highly probable that your computer is overheating—either the CPU or the graphics card. Open the cabinet and look to see whether the CPU fan is functional. Check if all the fans in the cabinet as well as those in the power supply are working. If possible, remove the CPU heatsink, clean the contact surfaces of the CPU and heatsink with a clean piece of cloth, apply a thin coat of thermal paste such as Arctic Ice, and replace the heatsink on the CPU. Neatly arrange and tie up all the wires and cables to allow free airflow. If possible, purchase a rounded IDE cable and install it in place of the flat ribbon cable.

Refer to *Going With The Flow* featured in our January 2007 issue for more about cabinet ventilation.

If the problem persists, the fault lies with your graphics card, and there is little that can be done except downloading (from www.nvidia.com) and installing the updated drivers for your card. If that doesn't help, you'll need to get a new one.

Switch Glitch

Q I have an Intel 915G based motherboard running Windows XP. When I try to play *The Sims 2*, I get the following error.

"The ialmrt5 display driver has stopped working normally. Save your work and reboot the system to restore full display functionality. The next time you reboot the machine a dialog will be displayed giving you a chance to upload data about this failure to Microsoft."

Manav Gowda

A Download and install the latest Intel graphics drivers for your onboard graphics from www.intel.com. If the problem persists, do the following. Right-click on the *The Sims 2* shortcut